

and listening to music. You can use the interface to sort your music as albums, genres and even use custom playlists. The Philips Rush holds second place. With its 'big stereo system' graphics, volume control displays and a simple interface, it is surely the most usable compact player around.

The Rio and the D-link were both very much similar in their approach to the interface and controls. Both have one round button in the front to navigate through the audio, and all other additional controls on the sides and around or below this button, but the D-Link shows the name of the song you're playing whereas the Rio doesn't.

Features

This was a real tiebreaker in this shootout as well as one of the major factors that helps you decide what kind of device you want. Features such as voice recording capability, FM radio and surround sound are the ones that add flavour and extra functionality to a device. Voice recording capabilities can enable you to use your MP3 player as a note taker, conversation recorder, and a dicta-phone. The same goes for FM radio; it's nice to be able to switch to something else when you run out of music to play from amongst those on the device.

Support for other upcoming formats such as Liquid Audio or Windows Media Audio (WMA) is another important feature. WMA sports a smaller file size as com-

pared to most MP3s with almost similar quality, thereby increasing the amount of content you can store on the device. Features such as upgradeable firmware and the ability to add extra memory, power the MP3 player with extra batteries or a car adapter, are also good features to have.

The **Nomad II MG** was the champ here. With an upgradeable firmware, it supports the ability to add 128 MB of extra memory to the player, extending the total memory to 196 MB. Just like the old Nomad, it also provides FM radio although you would have to be in a high reception range of the radio station to be able to get great reception. Voice recording and playback is a standard feature in the Nomad, Nomad II MG, and the D-Link DMP100. The Nomad Jukebox

SCORE
BOARD Specifications

The MP3 Players								
Model	Casio WMP-1V	Creative Nomad	Creative Nomad II MG	Creative Nomad Jukebox	Diamond Rio PMP300	D-Link DMP - 100	Philips Expanium	Philips Rush
Specifications								
Storage Space	16 MB	32 MB	64 MB	6 GB	32 MB	32 MB	650 MB	32 MB
Memory type	Solid state	Solid state	Solid state	Hard drive based	Solid state	Solid state	CD-ROM	Solid state
Connectivity option	Parallel	Parallel	USB cable	USB	Parallel	Parallel	None	Parallel
Features								
Voice Recording	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No
FM Radio reception	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	No
Upgradeable firmware	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
Expandable								
Memory	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Battery	No	No	No	No	No	No	No	No
Formats Supported								
MP3	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
WMA	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
WAV	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No
Upgrade	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
Performance								
Size	Easily Pocketable	Easily Pocketable	Easily Pocketable	Discman Size	Easily Pocketable	Easily Pocketable	Discman Size	Easily Pocketable
Interface	Normal	Normal	Normal	Easy	Easy	Easy	Hard	Easy
Display panel info	Inadequate	Inadequate	Adequate	Detailed	Inadequate	Adequate	Inadequate	Adequate
Build quality	Good	Good	Impeccable	Good	Good	Acceptable	Acceptable	Impeccable
Looks	Good	Real Cool	Real Cool	Good	Plain	Good	Good	Real Cool
Ergonomics	Poor	Poor	Acceptable	Smooth	Acceptable	Acceptable	Acceptable	Smooth
Ease of use	Hard	Normal	Normal	Easy	Easy	Easy	Normal	Easy
Battery life	Good	Good	Good	Poor	Good	Good	Good	Good
Maximum audio power	Poor	Average	Good	Poor	Good	Average	Good	Good
Audio Reproduction Accuracy	Poor	Good	Good	Good	Good	Average	Average	Poor
Skip Buffer/Audio consistency	Good	Good	Good	Good	Good	Good	Good	Good
Contact								
Price	Rs 14,995	Rs 13,500 (32 MB), Rs 17,000 (64 MB)	Rs 21,500	Rs 33,500	Rs 9,280	Rs 10,000	Rs 12,990	Rs 23,990
Vendor	Casio India Company	Compuage Infocom	Compuage Infocom	Compuage Infocom	Memphis Technologies	Dlink India	Phillips India	Phillips India
Phone	011-6534538	022-8305501	022-8305501	022-8305501	022-8523439	022-6902210	022-6912333	022-6912333
Rating	C+	B	B+	B+	B	B	B	B